



7-Minute Presentation Script

Secure Access, WAN Connectivity & Cloud Security Controls

CompTIA Security+ SY0-701 | Lesson 187.6 | Team 6



[0:00 – 1:00] — Opening & Cloud Data Protection

Speaker A:

"Hey everyone — today we're talking about something that's become critical in modern IT: how do we keep data secure when our workforce is fully remote and everything lives in the cloud?

Let's start with **cloud data protection**. Think about a company like Zoom or Salesforce — they run on AWS or Azure. The cloud provider secures the *physical infrastructure* — the servers, data centers, the network. But here's the key: **you**, as the customer, are responsible for encrypting your data, managing encryption keys, configuring DLP — Data Loss Prevention — and controlling access.

This is called the **Shared Responsibility Model**. It's not just a concept — it's a contractual boundary. AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud all publish their shared responsibility documentation, and it clearly draws the line: *they own the hardware, you own your data and how it's configured*.

Real-world example: In **2019, Capital One had a massive breach on AWS**. AWS's infrastructure was totally fine — the problem was a misconfigured firewall *the customer controlled*. Over 100 million customer records were exposed. That's the **shared responsibility model** in action — and a reminder that the cloud doesn't automatically mean secure."



[1:00 – 2:15] — SD-WAN

Speaker B:

"Great point. Now let's talk about how traffic gets from point A to point B securely — that's where **SD-WAN** comes in.

SD-WAN stands for **Software-Defined Wide Area Network**. Traditionally, companies paid for expensive dedicated MPLS circuits — think of it like leasing a private highway just for your company's traffic. SD-WAN replaces that with **encrypted tunnels over regular internet connections** — much cheaper and way more flexible.

It runs on three planes:

- The **control plane** makes routing decisions — it's the brain.
- The **data plane** moves the actual traffic and enforces security policies — it's the muscle.
- The **management plane** monitors everything and gives administrators visibility — it's the eyes.

What makes SD-WAN powerful is **application-aware routing**. It can detect that a video call needs low latency and route it differently than a file backup. That's intelligence traditional MPLS just doesn't have.

Real-world example: **Target** has hundreds of retail locations. Instead of paying for dedicated MPLS lines to every store, SD-WAN lets them route traffic over broadband with centralized policy management — cutting costs while keeping security consistent across every branch. Same policy, everywhere, managed from one dashboard."



[2:15 – 4:00] — SASE Architecture

Speaker A:

"Now here's where it gets really interesting — **SASE**, pronounced 'sassy' — Secure Access Service Edge.

SASE takes SD-WAN and bundles it with a full cloud-delivered security stack:

- **ZTNA** — Zero Trust Network Access: verifies every user and device before granting access
- **SWG** — Secure Web Gateway: filters malicious web traffic and enforces acceptable use policies
- **CASB** — Cloud Access Security Broker: monitors and controls data moving to and from cloud apps
- **FWaaS** — Firewall as a Service: delivers firewall protection from the cloud, no

hardware required

All of these run from the cloud — no appliances, no backhauling, no bottlenecks.

Here's the scenario that makes this click: Imagine **Sarah**, a remote worker in Chicago, trying to access Salesforce. With a traditional VPN, her traffic goes: *Chicago → VPN tunnel → Corporate HQ in New York → Internet → Salesforce*.

That's **backhauling** — slow, expensive, and a single point of failure. If HQ goes down, Sarah can't work."

Speaker B:

"Right — and with SASE, that same traffic goes: *Chicago → Nearest SASE Point of Presence (PoP) → Salesforce*.

At that PoP, ZTNA verifies Sarah's identity — *never trust, always verify* — the SWG scans for malware and phishing, CASB ensures she's not leaking data to an unauthorized app, and FWaaS applies firewall rules. All at the cloud edge, closest to where Sarah actually is.

The key principle here is **Zero Trust**: no user or device is trusted by default — not even if they're already inside the network. Every access request is authenticated, authorized, and continuously validated.

Real companies doing this? **Cisco Umbrella** and **Palo Alto Prisma Access** are both enterprise SASE platforms used by organizations worldwide to protect distributed workforces."



[4:00 – 5:15] — Comparison & Exam Tips

Speaker A:

"Let's quickly compare the three models side by side:

Model	Transport	Security	Trust Model	Cost
Traditional MPLS/VPN	Dedicated circuits	Perimeter firewall	Implicit trust	High
SD-WAN	Encrypted internet overlay	Centralized policy	Perimeter-leaning	Medium

SASE

Cloud-
delivered

Full stack
(ZTNA, SWG,
CASB, FWaaS)

Zero Trust

Subscription

For the exam — two things to lock in:

1. **SASE = SD-WAN + the full security stack, delivered as one cloud service.**
2. **ZTNA is a *component* of SASE** — not a replacement for it. If a question asks what SASE includes, ZTNA is on that list.

Also watch for distractors: SD-WAN alone does NOT include the full security stack. SASE does. That distinction shows up on exam questions."



[5:15 – 6:15] — Practice Question & Deep Dive

Speaker B:

"Let's work through an exam-style question:

A company's remote workers are complaining about slow performance when accessing SaaS apps through the corporate VPN. The security team wants to improve performance without reducing security inspection. What should they deploy?

A) More VPN concentrators **B)** SD-WAN at branch offices **C)** SASE with cloud-delivered PoPs **D)** Split tunneling

Let's eliminate:

- **A** — More VPN concentrators still backhaul traffic through HQ. You're just adding more of the same bottleneck.
- **B** — SD-WAN at branches improves routing but doesn't solve the cloud security inspection problem for remote *home* workers.
- **D** — Split tunneling speeds things up by bypassing the VPN for internet traffic — but that means *no security inspection* on that traffic. Hard no on the exam.

The answer is **C — SASE**. It routes traffic to the nearest PoP, applies full security inspection there, and delivers it directly to the SaaS app — fast *and* secure."



[6:15 – 7:00] — Wrap-Up & Key Takeaways

Speaker A:

"Let's bring it home. Three things to remember:

1. **Cloud security is a shared responsibility** — the provider secures the infrastructure, you secure your data and configurations.
2. **SD-WAN modernizes connectivity** — replacing expensive MPLS with intelligent, encrypted internet routing.
3. **SASE is the future** — it combines SD-WAN with a full Zero Trust security stack, delivered from the cloud, closest to the user.

The perimeter is dead. Security now lives in the cloud, at the edge, wherever your users are. SASE is how modern organizations protect their workforce without sacrificing performance.

Thanks for listening — we're happy to take any questions!"



Estimated Runtime: ~7 minutes | Pacing tips: slow down on the SASE architecture section and the practice question walkthrough — those are the highest-value moments for your audience. The comparison table and real-world examples (Capital One, Target, Sarah's VPN scenario) are your anchors.